Lesson 32

THE BIBLE, THE HOLY WORD OF GOD

Aim: To understand the Bible as The Holy Word of God.

Introduction:

"Tell your prince that this Book (the BIBLE) is the secret of England's greatness"-Queen Victoria, to an African Prince

"It is impossible to rightly govern the world without GOD and the BIBLE"-George Washington

Next to the gift of Christ and the Holy Spirit, the Bible is the third greatest gift. Sir Walter Scott, himself the author of many books and the possessor of a great library, said, "There is but one book, the Bible." The Bible is the oldest book in existence. It required sixteen centuries to write it, the first writer died 1450 years before the last writer was born.

The Bible lends itself to translation and has been translated in whole or in part in more than a thousand languages and dialects.

I. SEVEN CROWNING WONDERS OF THE BIBLE.

(Rev. Dyson Hague)

1. The wonder of its formation; one book written on one place and in one language. Another book written in one country centuries later in another language.

2. The wonder of its unification, it is the library of 66 books , yet only one book, for it has but one author, The. Holy Spirit. There are no contradictions.

3. The wonder of its age. It is the most ancient of all books.

4. The wonder of its sale, It is the best seller of all time.

5. The wonder of its interest. It is the only book that is read by all classes and ages of mankind. It is read by ages and children, read by all nations.

6. The wonder of its language. It was written by largely by uneducated men, yet it is considered a literary masterpiece.

7. The wonder of its preservation. It has been the most hated of all books. Time and again Kings and governments have sought to burn and abolish it. Yet God has preserved it for us today and it can be found in almost every home.

II. SEVEN SYMBOLS USED TO ILLUSTRATE THE WORD OF GOD

1. A Sword. The Bible is a pointed word that convicts the hearer.

Hebrews 4:12 - *12For the word of God is living and active. Sharper than any double edged sword, it penetrates even to dividing soul and spirit, joints and marrow; it judges the thoughts and attitudes of the heart.*

2. A Hammer. The Bible is powerful and breaks the resistance of the hearer.

Jeremiah 23:29, *29 "Is not my word like fire," declares the LORD, "and like a hammer that breaks a rock in pieces?*

3. A Seed. The Bible is a living Word regenerating the hearer.

1 Peter 1:23, *23For you have been born again, not of perishable seed, but of imperishable, through the living and enduring word of God.*

4. A Mirror. The Bible is a faithful Word, revealing the individual to himself.

James 1:23-24, *23Anyone who listens to the word but does not do what it says is like a man who looks at his face in a mirror*

5. A Fire. The Bible is a burning Word, consuming the dross in the hearer.

Jeremiah 20:9 *9 But if I say, "I will not mention him or speak any more in his name," his word is in my heart like a fire, a fire shut up in my bones. I am weary of holding it in; indeed, I cannot.*

Jeremiah 23:29, *29 "Is not my word like fire," declares the LORD, "and like a hammer that breaks a rock in pieces?*

6. A Lamp. The Bible is an Illuminating Word guiding the believer day by day.

Psalm 119:105, *105 Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light for my path.*

7. Food. The Bible is nourishing food, feeding the soul (Providing meat and drink)

1 Peter 2:2 - *2 Like newborn babies, crave pure spiritual milk, so that by it you may grow up in your salvation,*

1 Corinthians 3:2 - *2 I gave you milk, not solid food, for you were not yet ready for it. Indeed, you are still not ready.*

Romans 10:17 - *17 Consequently, faith comes from hearing the message, and the message is heard through the word of Christ.*

The word of God convicts, breaks, regenerates, reveals, consumes, illuminates and nourishes the individual.

III. SEVEN REASONS FOR PREACHING THE WORD OF GOD

In Mark 2:2, Jesus faced the multitude and made a tremendous decision; it was to preach the Word of God. We are sent to preach not a new church but Christ as He is revealed in the Bible.

We insist on preaching the Bible because it endures for time and eternity.

Isaiah 40:8 – *"The grass withers and the flowers fall, but the word of our God stands forever."*

1. Conviction of sin comes through the preaching of the Word of God.

Acts 2: 14-37. In Peter's Pentecost sermon nine verses out of twenty-three are quotations from the OT.

2. Faith comes by hearing the Word of God.

Romans 10:17- *17So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.*

3. Cleansing comes from the Word of God.

2 Corinthians 7:1 - *1Having therefore these promises, dearly beloved, let us cleanse ourselves from all filthiness*

of the flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God.

4. Assurance comes from the Word of God.

1 John 5:13- *13These things have I written unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God; that ye may know that ye have eternal life, and that ye may believe on the name of the Son of God.*

5. Comfort comes from the Word of God.

1 Thessalonians 4:18, *18Wherefore comfort one another with these words.*

6. Truth comes from the Word of God.

Acts 17:11, *11These were more noble than those in Thessalonica, in that they received the word with all readiness of mind, and searched the scriptures daily, whether those things were so.*

7. The New Birth comes from the Word of God.

1 Peter 1:23, *23Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth forever.*

IV. SEVEN POINTS TO REMEMBER IN READING THE BIBLE.

1. Read it lovingly.

The Bible is the Word of my Savior to me. Psalm 119:11

2. Read it reverently.

The Bible is the Word of God,

3. Read it prayerfully.

The Bible is God's message to me, to my own heart and life.

4. Read it meditatively.

Be like David of old and meditate on the word of God.

5. Read it systematically.

Read right through the Bible, not just selected portions.

6. Read it resolutely.

I will obey that which my father teaches me from His book.

7. Read it daily.

Not just on Sundays but everyday of your life read a portion.

CONCLUSION

Make the Bible your constant guide and companion in life. The Bible is the Word of God. it is worthy of being believed.

Breathe a prayer to the Holy Spirit to help you understand the sacred pages.